
Can we add juice without breaking our budget or deadline?
Campus Coffee-Cart Plan
Budget: $4,000
Target: 8 weeks
Fresh juice
Menu: drip coffee + tea
Approvals: not filed
Campus space: TBD
Food approvals: TBD
Equipment prices: TBD

What problem are we solving?

3 hours: 50-minute lesson, 10-minute break, 50-minute guided practice, 10-minute break, 50-minute applied practice, and 10-minute wrap-up.

SITUATION

The problem

A student club wants to open a campus coffee cart in eight weeks with a $4,000 budget. New requests can consume time and money the team does not have.

TARGET

Learning goal

Draft a small project outline that distinguishes included work, excluded work, unknown information, milestones, and dependencies.

Practice material: Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

Fictional scenario facts

- Three student volunteers; $4,000 maximum; eight-week target; initial menu is drip coffee and tea. Campus space and food approval are required, but applications are not filed. Equipment prices and approval timing are unknown; do not invent them.

BOUNDARY

Use the supplied facts

A student club wants to open a campus coffee cart in eight weeks with a $4,000 budget. New requests can consume time and money the team does not have.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Make the project boundary visible

- The coffee cart's first version has a $4,000 maximum budget and an eight-week target. Drip coffee and tea are in the initial menu. Fresh juice is not automatically included just because someone requests it. A scope statement names what the team will deliver now and what it will not deliver in this version. This prevents new ideas from quietly consuming the same limited time and money.

LEARN

Do not turn unknowns into plan facts

- Campus space and food approval are required, but applications are not filed. Equipment prices and approval timing are unknown. Mark these as "To confirm"; do not invent a price or a guaranteed approval date. A dependency is something the team needs from another person or office. A risk is an uncertain event that may affect the plan. Identify who can confirm an unknown and what work depends on the answer.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Evaluate a change request against the boundary

- If a student asks to add fresh juice two weeks before opening, check its effect on budget, schedule, equipment, approval, and labor before accepting it. The supplied facts do not confirm refrigeration, extra staff, or approval. A reasonable response is to defer the request or replace an existing menu item only after checking the missing requirements. Make a bounded recommendation instead of promising that every request can fit.

APPLY

Three-step method

- State the outcome, time, and budget; separate confirmed facts, exclusions, and unknowns; choose a few checkable milestones and identify the first dependency or risk.

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Write a complete plan for our coffee cart.

Message AI...

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Guarantee we open in eight weeks and include every idea students suggest.

Message AI...

A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Use only the scenario facts below. List confirmed facts and missing information.
Do not estimate prices or approval dates.
Ask exactly three questions that would change the launch plan.

Message AI...

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Draft a one-page project outline with launch outcome, included work, excluded work, three checkable milestones, one dependency, one risk,
and a next action. Keep the $4,000 limit and eight-week target visible.
Mark unknown prices or dates TBD. Do not invent facts.

Message AI...

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Provide the scenario facts to AI and run Improved Prompt 1. Mark unknowns TBD. Then run Improved Prompt 2. Check that coffee and tea are included, extra menu items are excluded, and no unsupported cost or approval date appears. Set a target week and checkable result for each milestone.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Two weeks before opening, a club member requests fresh juice without added budget or more time. Use the same outline to identify what needs checking. Recommend deferring the request or replacing an existing menu item. Do not assume refrigeration, approval, or extra labor is available.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W7_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- Introduction: Describe the coffee cart project, its $4,000 budget, and its eight-week deadline.
- Method: Copy Improved Prompts 1 and 2 and the prompt you used to check the juice request.
- Results: Include the project outline (included work, excluded work, TBD items, and milestones with target weeks) and your check that no unsupported cost or approval date appears.
- Conclusion: Give the short scope update: the juice request, its likely effect on time, cost, or approval, and one feasible next step.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- The plan preserves the budget and deadline, marks unknowns clearly, and lists milestones that can be checked.